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‘Not about the money?’ Celtics fans not buying it.

Honchos offer glimpse of why Brown was traded, but rationale still hollow

DAN SHAUGHNESSY

NBA rules prevented the Celtics from commenting on the trade that rocked New England sports when 10-year star Jaylen Brown was dealt to the Philadelphia 76ers for Paul George and a bunch of draft picks last Wednesday. The cone of silence was lifted Monday as Celtics president of basketball operations Brad Stevens and lead governor Bill Chisholm took questions for 45 minutes at the team’s practice facility in Allston.

“We’re not up here to defend our-

selves,” Stevens said in a 10-minute opening statement that used the word “optionality” several times.

The pledge was largely honored as Stevens admitted Brown was dealt because “the path looked a little bit more challenging to me with 70 percent of our cap — and such a high percentage of our usage tied into two players.”

Two players: That’s Jayson Tatum

and Jaylen Brown.

So one of them had to go.

And now Brown is gone: The man who gave the team 10 seasons and was MVP of the 2024 NBA Finals when the Celts won banner No. 18.

With this shocking swap, the Celtics said goodbye to the decade-long run of the two Jays. Making thing even worse, all the Celts truly have in exchange are two future first-round picks (one for 2031!) and a 36-year-old former star who’s played only 78 games over the last two seasons.

“I keep going back to myself as a kid and I don’t want to hear about

picks and ‘optionality,’” said Stevens. “Unfortunately, in my position, those things matter. That’s where we are . . . I’m not saying it was the right call.”

Does this trade make the Celtics better next season?

“We’ll find out,” he answered.

Can he see how this talent downgrade might be demoralizing for Celtic fans?

“I don’t think the team improves or doesn’t improve based on one player. Or subbing one player for another . . . I don’t know what you’re getting at necessarily.”

Swell. But Brad, can you ac-

SHAUGHNESSY, Page C4

Calls grow for Platner to drop his Senate bid

Democrat ‘taking the time to reflect’ after allegation of sexual assault surfaces

By James Pindell and Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

In a move that instantly upended one of the nation’s most pivotal Senate contests, Maine Democratic Senate nominee Graham Platner said Monday he is “taking the time to reflect on the best path forward” for his campaign against Republican Senator Susan Collins after an explosive allegation of sexual assault from a former girlfriend.

The statement came shortly after Politico reported that Jenny Racicot, a 41-year old Maine resident who used to date Platner, alleged he entered her home while intoxicated in 2021 and forced himself on her, despite her clearly not consenting.

In response, Platner recorded a direct-to-camera video saying that “any accusation of non-consensual behavior is categorically false.” In that video, he did not commit to remaining in the Senate race.

“Regardless of the inaccuracy of the reporting, but mindful the political reality it will inflict, we are taking the time to reflect on the best path forward for the state that I love, the people that I love, the movement I belong to, and the goal of defeating Susan Collins,” Platner said. “Those were the goals when we launched this campaign, and they remain my goals today.”

PLATNER, Page A7

Proctor’s racist texts jeopardize prosecutions

Slurs by ex-trooper may taint cases beyond Read

By Lea Skene

GLOBE STAFF

The Karen Read murder case revealed that former Massachusetts State Police trooper Michael Proctor sent misogynistic text messages, but the full scope of bigotry remained in the shadows.

That’s changing now, as more of his communications are appearing in recent legal filings in other cases. The ripple effects could be widespread.

The newly released messages contain a host of racist slurs, hateful language, and abhorrent jokes that together raise significant questions about the integrity of Proctor’s criminal investigations, especially in cases involving people of color and other minorities.

It’s the latest revelation in a protracted legal saga that has captivated a national audience and tarnished the reputation of Massachusetts law enforcement.

The implications are already being weighed in the 2021 murder case against Myles King, a Black man seeking to have his charges dismissed on the grounds that Proctor’s bigotry infected the entire investigation.

“You don’t just leave your racism at the court-

PROCTOR, Page A10

CUP RUN OVER



LUKE HALES/GETTY IMAGES



CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

What went wrong?

In the end, Belgium’s 11 were demonstrably better than what the US had to offer, John Powers writes, **C1**.

Controversy persists

Leaders of soccer organizations denounced FIFA’s decision to allow US striker Folarin Balogun to play. **C3**.



US goalkeeper Matt Freese (above) stood in disbelief after his bungling attempt of a pass led to a Belgian goal in a World Cup match in Seattle Monday. The United States’ tourney ended with a 4-1 loss, a pain shared by fans such as Forrest Johnson (left) at Big Night Live in Boston. **C1**.

In Cambridge, a little lost among the variables

8th-graders now must take algebra. It is, in summation, a struggle.

By Kate Taylor

THE HECHINGER REPORT

CAMBRIDGE — Ask parent Janina Matuszeski what she has valued most about her twins’ experience in the Cambridge Public Schools, and she is quick to cite the diversity and teacher quality.

If the schools have fallen short anywhere, it has been in math.

“Both my kids have been bored in math for many years,” said Matuszeski, a consultant and former lecturer at Harvard University’s Kennedy School of Government. “They’ll learn a concept in a day or a day and a half, and then the class will cover it for another two weeks.”

ALGEBRA, Page A10



LILY QIAN FOR THE HECHINGER REPORT



Troubled waters

Tuesday: Heavy rain, winds. High 66-71, low 61-66.

Wednesday: Sun returns. High 74-79, low 65-70.

High tide: 4:53, 5:22.

Sunrise: 5:15. Sunset: 8:23.

Weather and comics, **D5-6**. Obituaries, **C10**.

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More than 100 clambers packed a hearing with state officials to discuss when they can start digging for the famed Ipswich clams again after a sewer break in Haverhill. **B1**.

The number of people covered by the Affordable Care Act plummeted over the past year in states across the country. **A2**.

Donors have helped GBH cushion the blow of reduced federal funding. **D1**.

As Turkey welcomes Western leaders to the upcoming NATO summit, its standing within the organization has vastly improved. **A4**.

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